

Module 3

Understanding Human Being

In the previous module, we tried to understand the human being (the knower, the experiencer and the doer) and then went on to understand the interconnectedness and co-existence in the existence. With this we tried to look at the role of human being in existence (human conduct).

In this module, we are going to investigate about the human being in further depth. In the lecture 10 and 11, we will try to understand the human being as co-existence of the self and the body and do in-depth investigation into needs, activities and responses of both the self and the body. We had talked about it in the foundation course too.

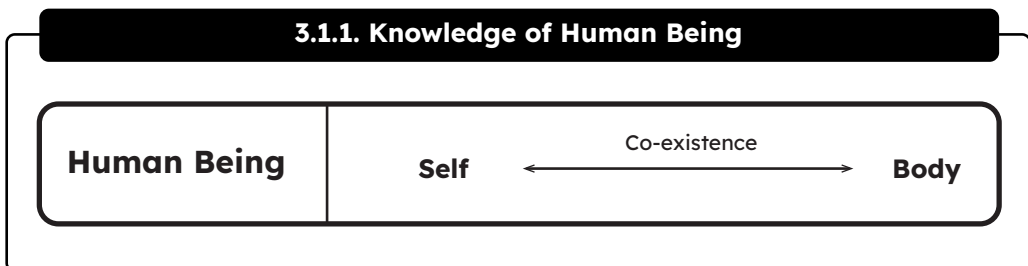
We will reinforce that by direct observation (through practice sessions - exercises 1 and 2). In the lectures 12-14, we will look into the activities and potentialities of the self in further depth and investigate the basis for harmony or reasons for contradiction in the self. With the above steps, we will get the clarity of our sources of happiness in lecture 15

Recap

So, far, we saw how self is central to human being, what the basic aspiration of a human being is and discussed the meaning of right understanding and resolution. With this, we also, discussed about the knower, the known and the process of knowing.

In this lecture, we will discuss about human being which is co-existence of the self and the body.

10.1 Human Being as Co-existence of Self and Body



We already discussed in the foundation course that human being is co-existence of self and body. Self is a conscious unit while body is a material unit and the two co-exist to make a human being. We tried to understand the two realities by looking at their needs, activities and responses distinctly a summary of which is given in the diagram below:

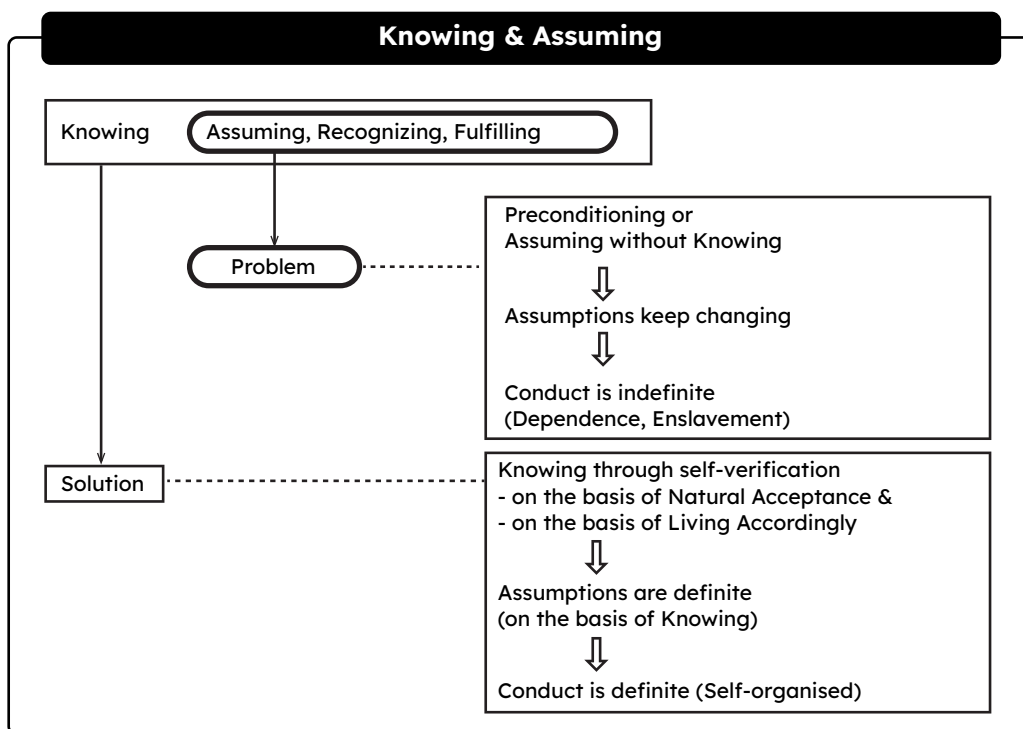
The need of the self is happiness and its need is continuous while the need of the body is physical facility and it is needed temporarily. The need of the self is qualitative while all the needs of the body are quantitative. The needs of the self are fulfilled by right understanding and right feeling while needs of the body are fulfilled by physio-chemical things.

Human Being		
	Self	Body
	Co-existence	
NEED	Happiness (e.g. Respect)	Physical Facility (e.g. Food)
In Time	Continuous	Temporary
In Quantity	Qualitative (is Feeling)	Quantitative (Required in Limited Quantity)
Fulfilled By	Right Understanding & Right Feeling	Physio-chemical Things
ACTIVITY	Desire, Thought, Expectation...	Eating, Walking...
In Time	Continuous	Temporary
RESPONSE	Knowing, Assuming, Recognising, Fulfilling	Recognising, Fulfilling
	↓ Consciousness	↓ Material

Further we explored the activities of the self and the body. We found that in the self there are activities like desire, thought, expectation which are continuous while the body has activities like eating, walking, sleeping etc which are temporary in nature. When we look at the responses, we see that the body has the response only in terms of recognizing and fulfilling, but the self has response in terms of knowing, assuming, recognizing and fulfilling. In every response of the self, assuming is involved and this assuming is not to be seen in the body. When the self has only assuming, recognizing and fulfilling, the conduct of the self is not definite as assumptions keep on changing. But when the knowing is ensured, then assuming is guided by knowing and then the conduct is definite.

If we study the activity of knowing and assuming further, we can see that operating in the domain of assuming, recognizing and fulfilling only is the domain of problem as we are preconditioned in multiple ways and the

preconditioning may vary from time to time. Thus, the conduct remains indefinite. But through education-sanskar, the knowing can be ensured and we can get resolution.



With these inputs, we could distinguish between the self and the body in our imagination and make our program accordingly.

Now, in this lecture, we will try to understand the two realities by direct observation.

10.2 Understanding the Human Being by Direct Observation

Let us start with exercises 1 and 2 which are given in Practice Sessions. A brief discussion on the basic content and process of the exercise will give us an idea about the possible outcome of it, on the basis of which we can conclude many things in studying human being. These exercises will help us to develop (a) right understanding and (b) purification of accumulated feelings and thoughts. In the process, we will find that we have accumulated a lot of feelings and thoughts which are otherwise, so, we must evaluate

them. Hence, first observe your thoughts, evaluate them and then purify them. This is the help you get through the practice sessions 1 and 2. The target of these exercises 1 and 2 as a whole is - living with fulfilment, living with continuous fulfilment that is the target of every human activity.

In the foundation course, we investigated into the basic human aspiration as continuity of happiness. We had also, concluded that in order to ensure continuous happiness, we need to develop three things which were discussed in the very first lecture of this course:

1. Right understanding – in the self
2. Right feeling and right thought – in the self
3. Competence for right living with the world outside.

When we say competence, the major part of it is at the level of self only. So, we are doing these exercises to develop these three things:

1. Right understanding in the self - which essentially, means right understanding of the existential reality which includes self, body, family, society, nature and the entire existence which we were exploring in the foundation course.
2. Right feeling and right thought in the self- i.e. the feeling of relationship, harmony and co-existence in the self and the thought based on this feeling.
3. Competence for right living with the world outside- i.e. living with feeling of relationship, harmony and co-existence with the world outside which expresses in terms of behaviour, work and participation in the larger order.

So, this is basically, the target, to have the focus on the right understanding, right feeling and right thought in the self and developing the necessary competence in the self.

The Major focus of these exercises

The major focus of these exercises is working on the self, instead of working on the self and the body together. Once we are able to see the self, we will

be better able to live in harmony within and also, ready to live in harmony with the world outside.

Our major focus, therefore, will be on ensuring:

1. Right understanding – of the existential reality in the self, and
2. Right feeling and right thought – of relationship, harmony and co-existence in the self.

To live in a fulfilling manner, we need to understand the existential reality in the self. To understand the reality, we need to observe that. In order to observe, we need to pay attention, we have to be mindful, we have to be aware of that reality. And through this process, when we are able to understand the reality, we are able to live with that reality in a meaningful manner and ensure fulfilment for ourselves and others forever.

If we are not able to understand it, we have some assumption about it which may be right or wrong, and therefore, we are likely to make mistakes while interacting with the reality. We tend to make mistakes living in the relationship if we do not understand the relationship. So, if you observe in your day-to-day life, even though you want to live with a feeling of relationship, you tend to get angry on small issues and this anger is not naturally acceptable. Therefore, with that anger, you are uncomfortable within, and you are making others uncomfortable too. You are feeling unhappy within and making others unhappy. Just find out if this is happening.

So, we need to pay attention, to observe, to understand and to live with fulfilment with any reality. Paying attention is the beginning point. There are two important aspects while paying attention

- a. One is to fix what the object of attention is
- b. Second is to see what the process of paying attention is. How do I pay attention?

Coming to the first point, when we look at the object of attention, we can see that our concern is living with fulfilment. Therefore, our object of attention is whatever is to be lived with, whatever we are living with. This is the whole range of object of attention. The process of paying attention is very simple.

If I want to pay attention to something, I just have to be aware of it, I have to make a decision that I have to be aware of this particular reality which I want to understand. So, if I make this decision, I can pay attention when I desire to pay attention. I can see that reality, and when I see that reality, I can understand this reality.

So, the process of paying attention is very simple: just making the decision of being aware of that particular reality. This is one important thing. The other important thing is that when I look at that reality, I should evaluate that reality without any reaction. And this is very important, because the moment you are in reaction, you are not able to see the reality as it is. You see the reality with your reaction, with your disturbed state of the self and therefore, your observation of the reality itself is coloured by that reaction.

When we look at the things to be understood, i.e., the objects of attention, we can see that we have to understand all that we live with - the self, the body, the family, the society, the nature and ultimately, the entire existence. These are the areas where we live. These are the levels of my, i.e., human existence. So, ultimately, we have to understand the entire existence. This is another important observation.

In the foundation course we have seen that this existence is in the form of co-existence which is in the form of units submerged in space. These are the two types of units: material units and consciousness units.

Basically, the whole existence is in the form of co-existence which is in the form of material and consciousness units submerged in space. So, we will try to understand these three things:

1. Self – the consciousness unit
2. The material unit (e.g., body) and
3. The co-existence, Space

For understanding these three things, we have three exercises, which we will try to work out.

In Exercise 1, we are trying to understand the consciousness, i.e., self in detail.

In Exercise 2, we are trying to understand the material, i.e., the body in detail. When we try to understand the material unit, we can begin with trying to understand the body, which is the material unit and with which I have a very live interaction so, it is easier for me to look into this body and my interaction with the body. We do that in Exercise 2.

We will briefly touch upon Exercise 3, which is for understanding the co-existence and understanding the space. We have not provided it in the Practice Sessions as it will require some further development of competence to accomplish, but we will briefly discuss it here.

This whole existence consists of material and conscious units submerged in space. So, we have a body as a material unit, we have self the consciousness unit, and of course, we have the co-existence of both. Because the self is the one who is understanding, who is going to pay attention, so, unless we understand the self first and feel satisfied, it will be very difficult to see the other things with clarity. Therefore, we will start with the self - the consciousness unit, and then we will work with the body and then ultimately, we have to work with the co-existence - the space.

One important point is when we are seeing, observing or paying attention - who is this seer? Who is the observer? Is it the self? Is it the body? It should be very clear by now that it is the self which sees or observes. We have been discussing it time and again but you can directly see for yourself. Or you can find out whether the self is the seer, the observer or the body is the seer, the observer. By direct observation, by directly looking at oneself, the self and the body, you can see that it is the self who is the seer, the observer. The body is used as an instrument as and when required. Eye or any such organ of the body is used as an instrument by the self as and when required.

So, if you look at this 'to see', 'to observe' it has to be done at the three levels.

1. Seeing the self by the self

The consciousness observing the consciousness. The self is the seer, and the self is the object of attention.

2. Seeing the body by the self

The consciousness observing the material. Self is the seer, and the body is the object of attention.

3. Seeing the co-existence by the self.

The consciousness observing the co-existence which includes

- Observing the distance between the self and the body,
- Observing the relationship between the self and the body

These three exercises are to be done by the self.

We are living within and the world outside. What we find is that our attention is outward most of the time. We are engaged with the world outside; we are engaged with the relationship and we have some assumptions about this relationship, about this outside world, and we are recognizing and fulfilling our relationship on the basis of this assumption. This is happening. When it is going on well, it is fine. But when there is a problem in this mutual expression in the relationship, in the world outside, then we are in trouble, we are confused. So, what to do? What we are saying is that as far as a human being is concerned, there are two possibilities:

(i) One is to just keep focussing outside.

(ii) The other is that we focus inside also.

We don't need to be looking outside all the time. Whenever necessary you can look at the world outside. This is an important observation. But it will be better if you first work inside within the self and ensure this Knowing and Assuming. And with this Knowing and Assuming, you participate outside. So, the order of our engagement is first within, inside, and then in the relationship outside. With this knowing and assuming that we have ensured in the self by working inside, we can recognise the relationship rightly and fulfill the relationship meaningfully in a mutually fulfilling manner. So, instead of just focusing attention outside, now we can start focusing attention inside to get the understanding, the knowing of the reality with which you are interacting.

The recognising and fulfilling which is based on knowing and assuming, which is taking place when I am working inside, becomes the basis of my definite conduct. This is important. This is what we need to do. So, in place of just working outside, engaging ourselves outside, it is more important

to engage ourselves inside. And then with the understanding, the clarity that we have obtained, we can interact with the world outside in a more meaningful manner.

Now, the question arises while I am observing the self, do I need the help of the eyes? e.g., one of the simplest ways of seeing myself is to see the imagination that is going on in me, the self. So, when I am observing my imagination which is going on in me, I am observing my desire, thought and expectation going on in me. Here, do I need to take help of my eyes, the physical eyes to see my imagination? Or I can see that imagination directly by paying attention to it? This is an important investigation and when we do this investigation which we need to do, it reflects that I don't need to use the eyes to observe my imagination. It is possible for me to see my imagination directly. This is important and if I can see this, I can see that the body, i.e., eyes are not important in this observation. So, I can give rest to the eyes, I can put it in a position where it is comfortable. This is one thing. Similarly, when I am looking at the self, imagination in the self by the self, do I need to use the body? Do I have to take any work from the body? And the answer is NO. Because I am directly observing the self by the self, imagination by the self, there is no involvement of the body required. So, I can give rest to the body. I can keep the body in any comfortable position and I can start working with the self.

So, we need to work on these two exercises. Exercise 1 will give us a feel about the self, the activity of the self, need of the self and so on. And similarly, Exercise 2 will give us a feel of the body, need of the body, the activities of the body, the response of the body. All those things can be directly observed and that is what we intend to do. So, through the Exercises 1 and 2, we will try to see things about the self, about the body, interaction between the self and the body. And that will help us in the process of understanding the self, the body and the interaction between the two.

There are a few points for observation here:

1. Observe yourself and your interaction with the body. Now, check by direct observation whether there is
 - Need of happiness in the self? Every moment?

- Need of physical facility (like food) for the body? From time to time, not every moment (temporary)?

Now you observe this directly through your interaction with the body

2. Observe yourself and your interaction with the body. Now, check by direct observation whether
 - The recognition and fulfilment of the body is definite, while
 - The recognition and fulfilment of the self is dependent on its assuming or knowing and assuming.
3. Observation of activities of the self was made in detail in Exercise 1. You further need to observe the activities of the body and see that they are not continuous.

So, when you observe the activities of the self, you will see that they are continuous and when you observe the activities of the body you will see that they are not continuous.

Key Takeaways

We need to understand the existence of self and body by direct observation for which exercise 1 and 2 can be utilized: Seeing the self by the self and seeing the body by the self.

Lecture 11

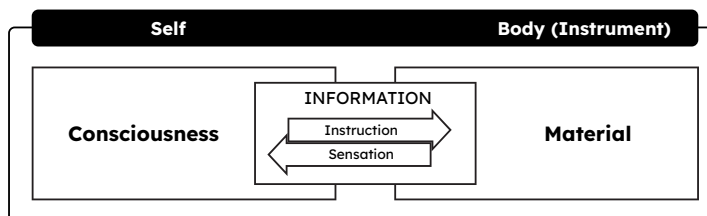
Interaction between the Self and the Body

Recap

In the previous lecture, we tried to see the self and the body through direct observation. In this lecture, we want to understand the interaction between the two.

11.1 Interaction between the Self and the Body

The interaction between the self and the body is taking place in the form of information only.



There is no physical transaction taking place. For example, when you instruct the body to go to the sweet shop, order for a sweet, take out some money and pay, the body acts accordingly. When you put the sweet on your tongue, there is some taste of the sweet. You read that generated sensation and give some information to the body instructing to ask for one more. It is exactly happening between me and the body. The instruction given from self to the body is information. The sensation received by the body is also, information. The sweet remains with the body once it goes down the throat. It is now a part of the body which will either nurture or harm the body. The self does not get anything out of it. Exercise-2 (mentioned in the previous lecture) is basically, based on observing the self, the body and their interaction. All these observations are done by the self through seven steps of the exercise. In this lecture, we are going to see the transaction between the two in detail.

With the exercises, we can conclude that I exist and I can also see that the body exists. How do I see that the body exists? I see it by observing the sensation from the body. I see the body when my eyes are open; I can see the shape, colour of the body and conclude that the body exists. It is interesting to observe that I can see the body even if I close my eyes with the help of sensations. If you are not reading the sensations coming from the body, there is no way for you to find out whether the body is there or not. With the observation, we can conclude that there are two distinct realities, the self and the body.

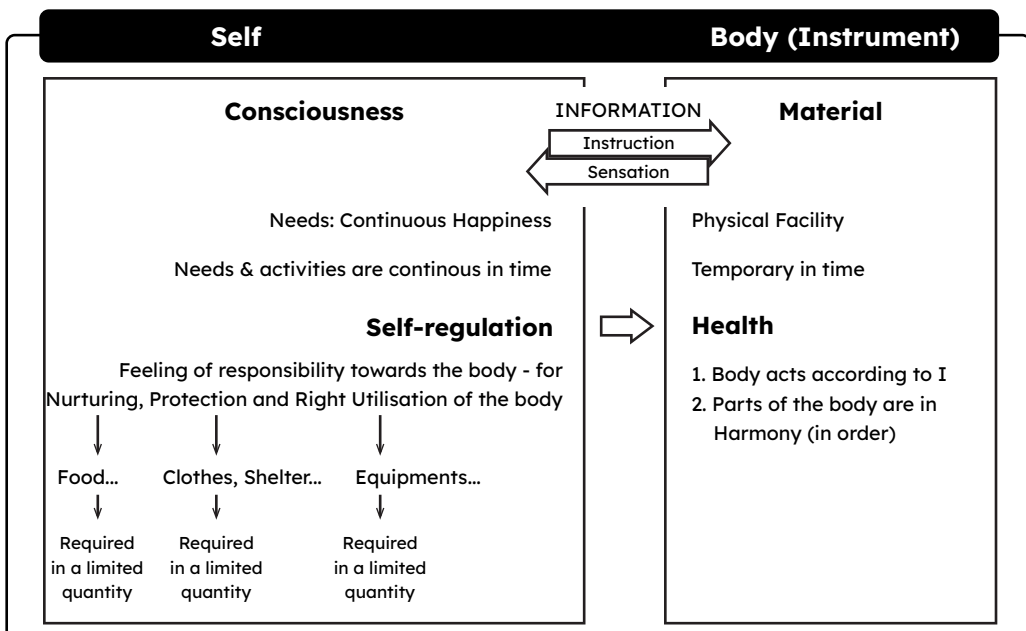
The next question is what the interaction is between the self and the body. Is there only exchange of information or exchange of physio-chemical things too? Though we have already studied it in Exercise-2, we are briefing here with some examples. For example, when I want to take some work from the body, I give it some instructions like get up, get down, and you can see that this instruction is just information. Similarly, we can see that something is happening at the level of the body. For example, if there is cold outside, there is shivering in the body. I read that sensation from the body in the form of information. There is no material transaction between the two.

Another important point to be noted is that we interact with the body as and when required. We are not interacting with the body all the time. The percentage of transaction is very less. Most of the time, we are busy with our self and not paying attention to the body or not doing any transactions with the body. When the self is not paying attention to the body, there is no transaction between the self and the body which we studied in the second step of the Exercise-2. The third step shows that I can see that there is only transaction of information between the two, and the self decides what to instruct and when to instruct. Similarly, I decide when to read the sensation from the body because there are a number of sensations taking place at the level of the body, and I am not reading all of them. Both ways, the decision is in the self and the transaction is taking place from the self to the body or from the body to the self. Therefore, I use the body as my instrument, as per my decision.

I have to observe the whole process so, that I may become authentic about

the two realities. Now, we can conclude that it is the self who is deciding; it is the self who is observing; it is the self who is enjoyer in terms of experiencing the result as happiness or unhappiness. Next important question we can ask ourselves during observing the sensations – Am I sensation? We can find that I am not a sensation because, if I was the sensation, there was no way for me to read out the sensations. Therefore, I am not a sensation. In fact, we can see that we are at a distance from sensations.

11.2 Feeling of Self-regulation and its Natural Outcome



Now we can distinguish between the need of the self and body. The need for the self is happiness in continuity. The need of the body is the physical facility. Now we can directly observe that the needs and activities of the self are continuous and those of the body are temporary in time. Once we are able to see that the body is instrument of the self, we become responsible to the body, we have the feeling of responsibility towards the body for nurturing protection and the right utilization of the body.

This is the feeling of self-regulation. As a natural outcome, the body acts according to the self. Now, with the feeling of self-regulation, the needs of physical facility can be quantified. We need things like food and water for

nurturing the body; we need things like cloth, shelter and so on for protection of the body; we need some instruments to participate in the family and society. With this context, all the needs of physical facility are limited in quantity.

Now, with this understanding, we can discuss the feeling of prosperity- the feeling of having or producing more than required physical facility. For this feeling, we need two things:

1. Identification of required physical facility which can be ensured through right understanding
2. Right skills to acquire required physical facility.

If you are prosperous, you think about the right utilization and nurturing others.

With lack of the feeling of prosperity, there are two kinds of people

- (a) People lacking physical facility, unhappy and deprived
- (b) People having physical facility, unhappy and deprived

While what we really want to be is—

- (c) People having physical facility, happy and prosperous

With the proper understanding of the self, the body and their interaction, we can shift from (a) and (b) to (c).

The gross misunderstanding today is that we are assuming our self as body and we think that respect can be obtained with the physical facility. As a result, we try to ensure continuity of happiness by physical facility or sensation. And we start feeling that the need of the physical facility is unlimited which leads to a tendency of accumulating more and more physical facility. As a result, we feel deprived and trapped in a vicious cycle of accumulating physical facility because of the lack of understanding of the self, the body and their interactions.

In the light of the above we can do some homework:

- a. If you are able to see by direct observation that need of the self is for continuous happiness and it is fulfilled by the activity of the self not by

the physical facility, find out the need of physical facility for all the three purposes.

- b. Find out if you are making the selection for physical facility with the feeling of the self-regulation or for sensation. For example, is the food selected by you meant for nurturing the body or to get happiness out of the sensation?
- c. Find out how much your body is affected by the state of the self. For example, when you are angry, what is the effect on the body? This is very important to study because presently, we are existing with the body quite unknowingly. There is some problem at the level of self, and it gets reflected at the level of the body very unconsciously, very unknowingly. Now we have started observing with awareness. If something is happening in the self, is it required to pass to the body? Am I giving some instruction to the body when I am angry, when I am upset? So, I can keep working on myself and pass the decision as and when required.

Key Takeaways

There is interaction between the self and the body in terms of information only. The self gets sensation from the body and gives instruction to the body. When the self has the feeling of self-regulation for the body, there is feeling of prosperity in the self and health in the body. We need to directly observe the interaction between the self and the body.

Lecture 12

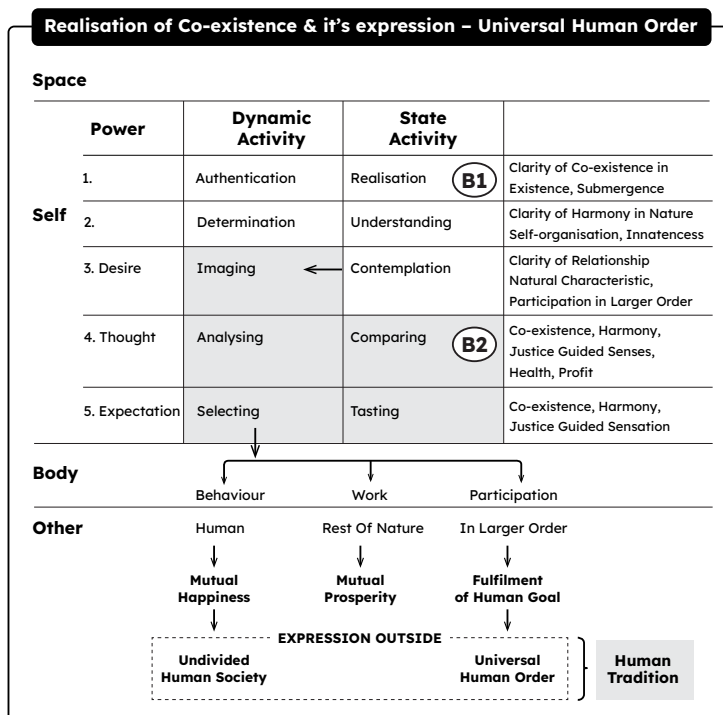
Higher Activities of the Self

Recap

In the previous two lectures, we talked about the self, the body and their interactions through direct observation.

In this lecture, we want to investigate into the higher activities of the self.

12.1 Higher Activities of the Self



We discussed about the activities of the self in the foundation course too. In this course, we are going to study the activities of the self in more detail. In the above diagram, which was referred to earlier also, we can see that there is a sequence of developments, a sequence of self-evolution that we have to talk about. There are two blocks in the diagram above. B1 is the block of right understanding and B2 is the block of imagination.

Most of the time, we are busy at the level of expectation, with tasting and selecting, and not aware of these higher activities and living in animal consciousness. But naturally, we all feel to evolve at the level of the self. There is a possibility of evolution in existence because the basic guidance of this evolution in terms of our natural acceptance is available to all of us without any corruption and impurity.

If we want to evolve, we have to start looking at the basic reference and from that, drive our inspiration, our guidance. If we do that self-development, self-evolution will take place very naturally and that is what we are trying to do. The most basic thing is that we are working with tasting and selecting. We can also, see that the activity of imagination is going on predominantly, but most of the time our major concern is either the body or the world outside. When we transform to this higher level through self-exploration, through self-verification, gradually we are awakening our self to the higher activities of the self.

So, first we are awakening to the activity of the contemplation, where I can see my relationship with other units in nature. I can see my participation in the larger order; I can see my natural characteristic; I can see that I am in relationship with other units. I can see that there is definite participation, definite role to play in that relationship, in that order. This is what contemplation is. Thus, I am able to see my natural characteristics, I can see what is natural to me in my relationship. For example, in relationship with human being, the feelings of trust, respect become a part of my contemplation. And the result that we get out of this clarity is very definite, universal and continuous. So from there, that element of definiteness starts showing up.

We don't have to stop there; we only have to evolve to still higher activity of understanding. When we awaken our self to the higher activity of understanding, we are able to see our own harmony, our own selforganization, our own innateness. The next activity is realization. If I look at the realization of co-existence at the level of self, I need to realize that I am in co-existence in space. I am in space; I am in co-existence in space; I am energized in space; I am self-organized in space and so on. These possibilities are there

and as we go on moving to the awakening of higher activities, I can see that the whole existence is co-existence, the whole nature is in harmony and I can also, see what role I have to play in this relationship, in this harmony, in this co-existence. So, let's look at them and unfold them one by one.

We have the activities of imagination at the level of B2 and the activities of right understanding at the level of B1. We can see that most of the time we are busy with the activities of B2 (imagination). Now, we have to awaken our self to these higher activities - the activity of contemplation, understanding and realization. We will explore these activities and then see how we can be active at this level of consciousness.

12.2 Right Understanding – Awakening to Higher Activities of Self

Right understanding is essentially, seeing the essence of the reality as it is, i.e., seeing that part of the reality that is definite, universal and continuous. Three things are to be seen: (i) the natural characteristic, the participation in larger order of that particular reality (ii) the innateness, the self-organization of that reality and (iii) the co-existence, the submergence of that reality, that unit. This way, we will be having the understanding of the essence of those dimensions of the reality which are definite, universal and continuous. So, by investigating at the level of higher activities of the self, we will be able to see that the units are not in isolation but in relationship, the units are not disorganized, rather they are in harmony. And finally we will see the units in co-existence in space. All the units of Nature can be divided into four orders – physical, bio, animal and human order. And we can study the innateness and natural characteristics of the four orders in nature.

12.3 Innateness and Natural Characteristics of Four Orders in Nature

All the four orders have definite natural characteristics and innateness, and we have to understand the innateness and natural characteristics for each of the four orders. But ultimately, the co-existence is common to all of them. These are the nine things which we really have to understand. So, we have to awaken our self to these nine things. If we recall the lectures 7 and 8, we already

understood the activity of contemplation, understanding and realization. Describing briefly, the contemplation is having the clarity of relationship, natural characteristic, participation in larger order. Understanding is the clarity of harmony in nature, clarity of selforganization, innateness of every unit and ultimately, the whole Nature, and realization is having clarity of co-existence in existence, having clarity of submergence of units in space. The clarity of these is essential for awakening to the higher activity. In the light of these higher activities of the self, now, we will like to see how things work.

One important observation is that in the light of the higher activities of the self, the lower activities of the self also start getting reorganized. It is shown through the arrow from contemplation to imaging which is guiding my lower activity and once that happens, my desires will become definite, and my thought and expectation will be in line with that understanding. When these activities guide our imagination, our very basic criteria of the lower activities of the self will be guided by this clarity about co-existence, harmony and justice. We can use the word justice for fulfilment of relationship. Now my basis of comparison becomes the co-existence, harmony and relationship which was earlier based on only sensation and some aspects of health and profit. Similarly, my expectation is also guided by the co-existence, harmony and relationship not just by the sensation. So, this is the change in my lower activities. We can look into the details of the changes in the lower activities of the self how they would look like. That we may do in the next session.

12.4 Recap of Step 5, 6 and 7 of Exercise 1

The important point is that now the above proposal can be verified or looked into through direct observation. So, whatever seems to be logically and rationally correct is not enough. We have to now start observing this as a reality in existence by direct observation that we have been practicing in Exercise 1. In this lecture, we see briefly about the steps 5, 6 and 7 of Exercise 1 so, that we can study into higher activities with more confidence, assurance and we can verify the higher activities and the content of these higher activities by direct observation. So, let us look at steps 5, 6 and 7 in Exercise 1. In Exercise 1 we have seen that ultimately, it is me, the self, who

is taking decision about my feelings. That was an important deduction that we made in Step 4. I am taking the decision whether to have a feeling of trust or mistrust, to have feeling of relationship or feeling of opposition, with regard to the circumstances around. For any given circumstance, I always have the choice to decide my feelings. I am the one who is taking the decision; therefore, I am the one who is responsible for happiness or unhappiness which is borne out of this feeling that I have decided for.

In step 5, we saw that the decision about the feeling is either based on understanding of the reality or an assumption in the absence of understanding of that reality.

In Step 6, we have two parts (i) Step 6(a) and (ii) Step 6(b). In Step 6(a), we are investigating what is naturally acceptable to us -feeling of relationship or opposition; harmony or disharmony; co-existence or struggle. When we do this investigation, we get the answer that the relationship, harmony and co-existence is naturally acceptable as a feeling. The feeling otherwise is not naturally acceptable to us. In step 6(b) now we have decided for the feeling of relationship, harmony and co-existence and then, we are trying to understand this relationship, harmony and co-existence. And, when we want to study about relationship, harmony and co-existence, we essentially, have to start working with these higher activities of the self: the contemplation, the understanding and the realization. Contemplating on relationship means to see our relationship with every unit of nature; understanding harmony means to see that continuous happiness is our innateness; realizing co-existence means to see that I, the self, am in co-existence in space, am submerged in space and so, is every unit in the Nature. With this background, now we can see step 7.

In Step 7, we are trying to ensure that the feeling that I have at this moment is in line with the relationship, harmony and co-existence which ensure my happiness in continuity. So, the Step 6 and 7 constitutes the major part of this course because throughout the course we are trying to understand the relationship, harmony and co-existence, and then we are trying to make sure that all our desires and thoughts are in line with this relationship, harmony and co-existence.

12.5 Realization of Co-existence and it's Expression – Universal Human Order

With the steps explored above, when the self has awakened to the higher activities, i.e., contemplation, understanding, and realization, then these awakened activities are now guiding the lower activities of the self like comparing and tasting. Once that state is achieved now, I can see that the lower activities are getting modified. Now, the contemplation becomes the basis of my desire, my imaging and this is now guiding my thought and expectation. And with all this in place, the self is in the state of harmony within, in the state of happiness within even when I am not expressing anything at the level of outside world. With this, whenever I interact with the other person, I will always interact on the basis of these naturally accepted feelings, and if I do that, it leads to mutual happiness, mutual prosperity and fulfilment of human goal and ultimately, to the undivided human society and universal human order. So, all that will come as a natural outcome of my awakening to the higher activities of the self. If this happens, I will be in the state of harmony within and that harmony will show up at different levels: at the level of understanding this harmony will show up as BLISS; at the level of contemplation, it will show up as SATISFACTION; at the level of comparing-analyzing it will show up as PEACE and at the level of selecting-tasting it will show up as HAPPINESS. These states of Bliss, Satisfaction, Peace and Happiness are basically, an outcome of state of the activities of the self. This is the way we can ensure harmony in self at all levels of activity. With this state of happiness, peace, satisfaction and bliss, now I can work outside in a mutually fulfilling manner. So, this mutually fulfilling behavior with world outside, work with world outside is going to be just a natural outcome of my state of the self.

Key Takeaways

Right understanding is seeing the essence of the reality, i.e., contemplation of the natural characteristic, understanding of innateness, and realization of submergence of all the four orders of nature in space. This reflects as bliss, satisfaction, peace and happiness in the self.

Lecture 13

Basis for Analysing- Comparing

Recap

In the previous lecture, we understood the activities of realization, understanding and contemplation. This understanding will now guide the desire, i.e., imaging of the self, and now the desire naturally becomes to live with co-existence, harmony and relationship.

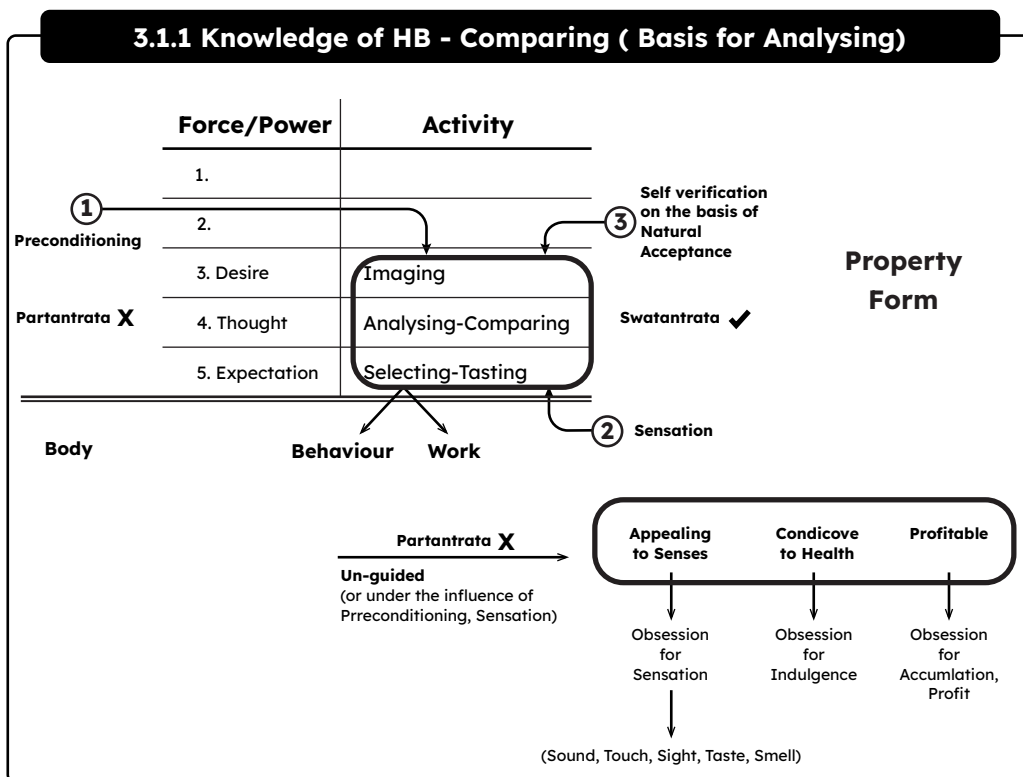
Now, we would like to look into the impact of higher activities of the self on lower activities. In this lecture, we will discuss the impact on thought.

13.1 Higher Activities Guiding Lower Activities

Block B1 shows the higher activities of the self while the block B2 shows the lower activities. The higher activities of the self guide the lower activities of the self. We have to be aware whether this is happening in us or not. If it is not happening, we have to find out the reason. I have to evaluate whether I am unaware of my imagination or the right understanding has not taken place in me. If the right understanding had taken place in me, I would be aware in myself and the activities of B1 would be guiding my desire in accordance with co-existence, harmony and relationship. Isn't it? When we understand human-human relationship, values in human-human relationship, our desire is to live with those values in human-human relationship. For example, when you see the feeling of trust clearly, finding intention to be pure in every human being while competence may be lacking, it makes all the difference in your desire to participate in your relationships. So, this is one thing that the arrow indicating from the contemplation to imaging is essentially, showing that my desire is now guided by contemplation, understanding and realization of harmony in relationship.

13.2 Impact of Higher Activities on Analyzing and Comparing

Now we will see how the higher activities impact the analyzing and comparing. We learned in the foundation course that our imagination is motivated by three sources – (i) preconditioning, (ii) sensation and (iii) natural acceptance. And that is something that we have been mentioning time and again.

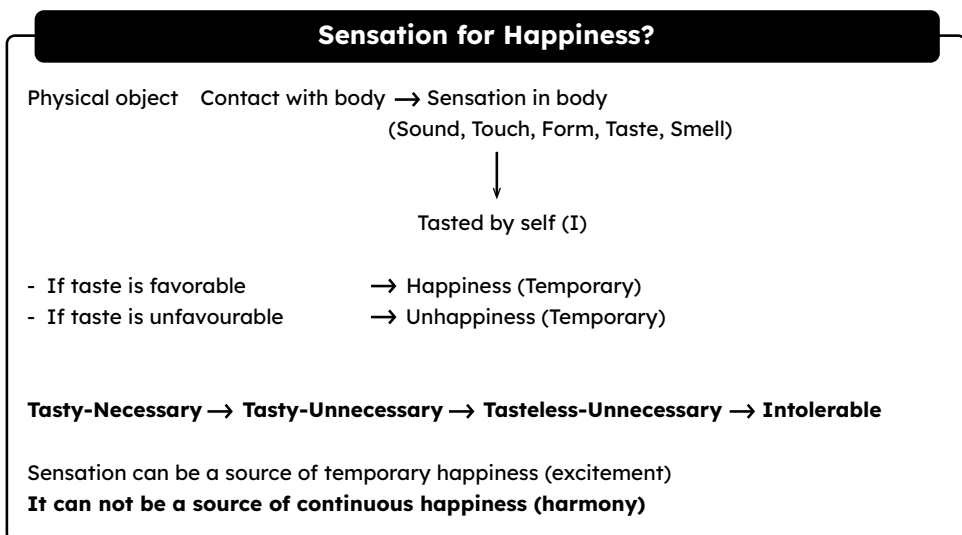


If you are not referring to the higher activities, what will be the basis of your thought, basis of analyzing and comparing? Without the reference of higher activities, the following references may happen in the self:

- One basis may be the sensation where something is appealing to senses. If something is appealing to senses, we have a liking for it, and on the basis of that we start analyzing. For example, whenever you select food, the decision may be based on taste (favourable sensation).

- The other basis could be conducive to health (or consumption with expectation for health), whether it leads to good health or bad health?
- And third is whether it will lead to some profit from acquiring of the physical facility or not.
- So, these are the three possible bases for your thinking. If it continues it may lead to three types of obsessions—
 - (i) Obsession for sensation,
 - (ii) Obsession for consumption/indulgence and
 - (iii) Obsession for profit.

If we look at our way of life, all three of them are very dominant and leading to the majority of our problems in society. So, many crimes are taking place today because of obsession for sensations; so, many problems of health today because of obsession for consumption etc.

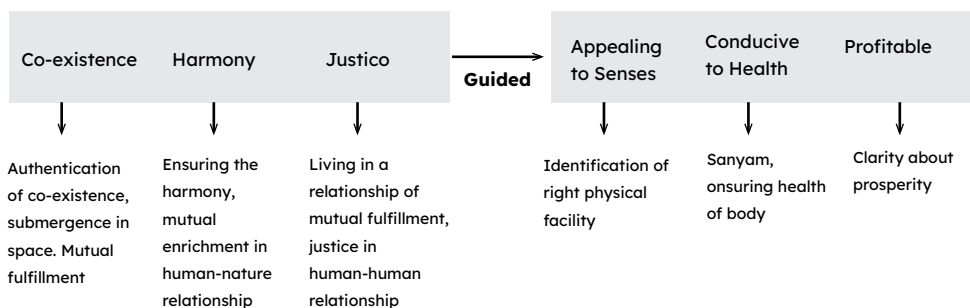


Now let us study about the sensations. The sensations can be of five types: sound, touch, sight, smell and taste. As discussed earlier, sensation is the information that the self gets from the body. If you study the complete sequence, it is like this: there is a physical object and it comes in contact with the body. Then there is sensation in the body which is tasted by the self. If the taste is favorable, we may feel happy but temporarily. If the taste is

unfavorable, we feel unhappy which is also, temporary. It is more like an excitement. When you are engaging yourself in any taste of sensation, it passes through the whole process as shown in the diagram above. Initially, it is tasty and necessary. Then it is tasty but unnecessary. After some time, it becomes even tasteless. And if you will still continue, it becomes intolerable. Observe it for any kind of sensation from which we try to derive happiness. The important conclusion out of this is that the sensation can be a source of temporary happiness or source of excitement only. It cannot be a source of continuous happiness, so, this is the thing that you have to study and see.

When you look at animals, the sensation in animals is naturally restrained (in nature) for health. But a human being can go for sensation while harming one's body. A human being can make right utilisation of sensation only with right understanding.

3.1.1 Knowledge of HB - Comparing (Basis for Analysing)



Space

	Power	Dynamic Activity	State Activity		
Self	1.	Authentication	Realisation (B1)	Co-existence	Co-existence
	2.	Determination	Understanding	Harmony in Nature	Innateness
	3. Desire	Imaging ←	Contemplation	Participation in Larger Order, Relationship	Natural Characteristic
	4. Thought	Analysing	Comparing (B2)	Co-existence, Harmony, Justice Guided Sensation, Health, Profit	Property Form
	5. Expectation	Selecting	Tasting	Goal, Value Guided Sensation	
Body					
		Behaviour	Work	Participation	
Other					
		Human	Rest Of Nature	In Larger Order	

In the light of the higher activities, the role of sensations become:

- (i) To keep body in good health by nurturing, protection of body
- (ii) To exchange right understanding and right feeling (Education-sanskar).

Therefore, sensation is not bad in itself. It has to be utilized for the purpose of relationship, harmony and co-existence. We can make right utilization of sensation only by right understanding. So, this guidance has to come from the top (B1), from the higher activities only.

Similarly, in the light of the higher activities, we can talk about the right utilization of the body which is an instrument of the self. The following is the right utilization of the body:

1. As an instrument for communication
2. As an instrument for labour, to obtain necessary physical facility for the body
3. As an instrument for continuity of Human Tradition (new body)

Comparing (Basis for Analysing)

Authentication of co-existence, the submergence in space

Authentication of harmony, i.e. human-nature relationship, mutual enrichment (mutual prosperity)

Authentication of relationship, i.e. human-human relationship, mutual fulfillment (mutual happiness)

↓ **Guided**

For identification of physical facility that is nurturing for the body, for protection of body, for behaviour / work, sharing knowledge, feeling

Self-regulation, clarity about program for self-regulation ensuring health of body, so that body is capable of being used for ensuring right understanding and right feeling in the self as well as its authentication in living, including behavior, work and participation in larger order

For clarity about prosperity (identification, production & right utilisation of physical facility), so that nurturing, protection and right utilisation of the body and right utilisation of physical facility is ensured for relationship and societal order

Similarly, in the light of the higher activities, the role of Physical Facility or right utilization of Physical Facility is

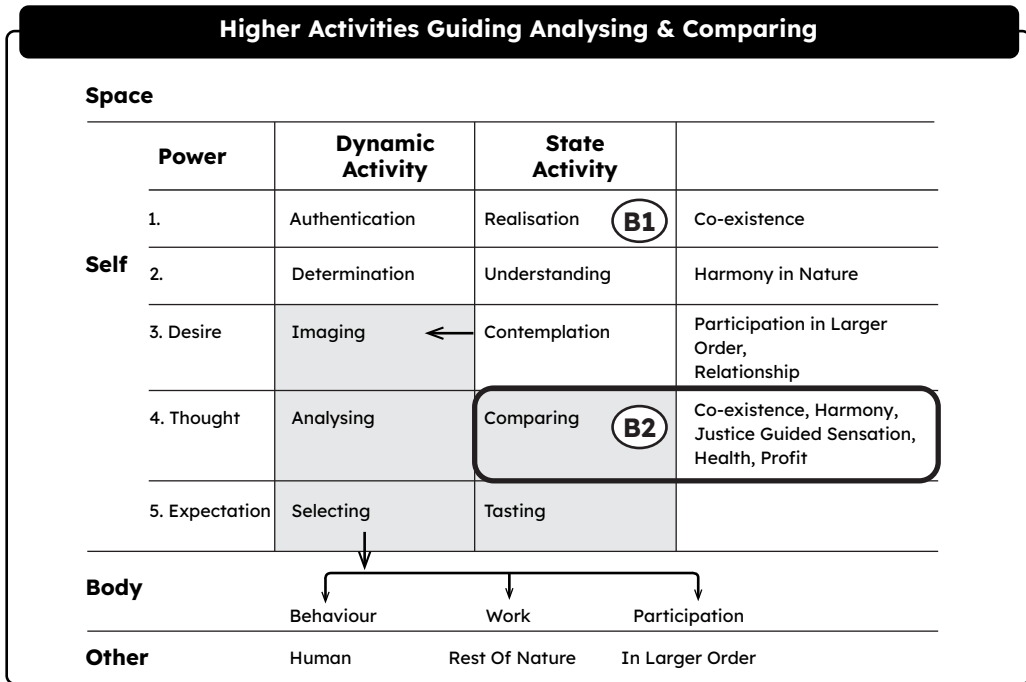
1. For nurturing, protection of body
2. For exchanging right understanding and right feeling (Education-sanskar) and other aspects of social system

If higher activities are guiding the activities of analyzing and comparing, the basis of analyzing and comparing become co-existence, harmony and relationship. Now, we primarily work for our realization of coexistence; for ensuring harmony at all levels; for ensuring fulfilment in relationship, and it becomes the basis of our thoughts, that means the basis of deciding what activities to do and what not to do. The activities of analyzing and comparing were going on in the self earlier as well on the basis of sensation, consumption and profit. Now, they are guided by the higher activities of the self.

For example, when I'm eating something, I look at the taste of it, and then decide whether it is nurturing the body or not. So, the same sensation is used for keeping the body in good health by nurturing it, protecting it thereby ensuring the fulfilment of my relationship with the body. Similarly, when you put something in your mouth and you find that it is rotten, how do you sense that it is rotten? It is sensed by the sensation. And because it is rotten it is not good for health. By this way, now sensation is used for deciding whether it is going to be a source of health, source of nurturing and protection of the body or not. Similarly, when I am saying something, I am listening to something. I can check whether it is to ensure right understanding, right feeling or otherwise. So, sensation can be used for the purposes of sharing right understanding, right feeling and for ensuring harmony and relationship.

The criterion of basis of conducive to health will be used for ensuring the health of the body and the feeling of *Sanyam* or self-regulation in the self, thereby ensuring the fulfilment of relationship of the self with the body. The Profit will now be showing up in terms of identifying the need of physical facility and ensuring more than what is required and therefore, leading to the feeling of prosperity. This feeling of prosperity is an indicator of fulfilment of my relationship with the nature including the body. Therefore, we now will

have the clarity about prosperity. This is how our basis of thought, our basis of comparing, our basis of analyzing will get transformed in the light of higher activities of the self shown in the diagram given below and marked with a circle.



Key Takeaways

Without awakening of higher activities of the self, thought is unguided. In such a state, the basis for comparing is ‘appealing to senses’ or ‘conductive to health’ or profit. This may lead to obsession for sensation or consumption or profit. As the higher activities are awakened, the basis for comparing is co-existence, harmony and justice. Now the role of sensation and physical facility gets properly defined.

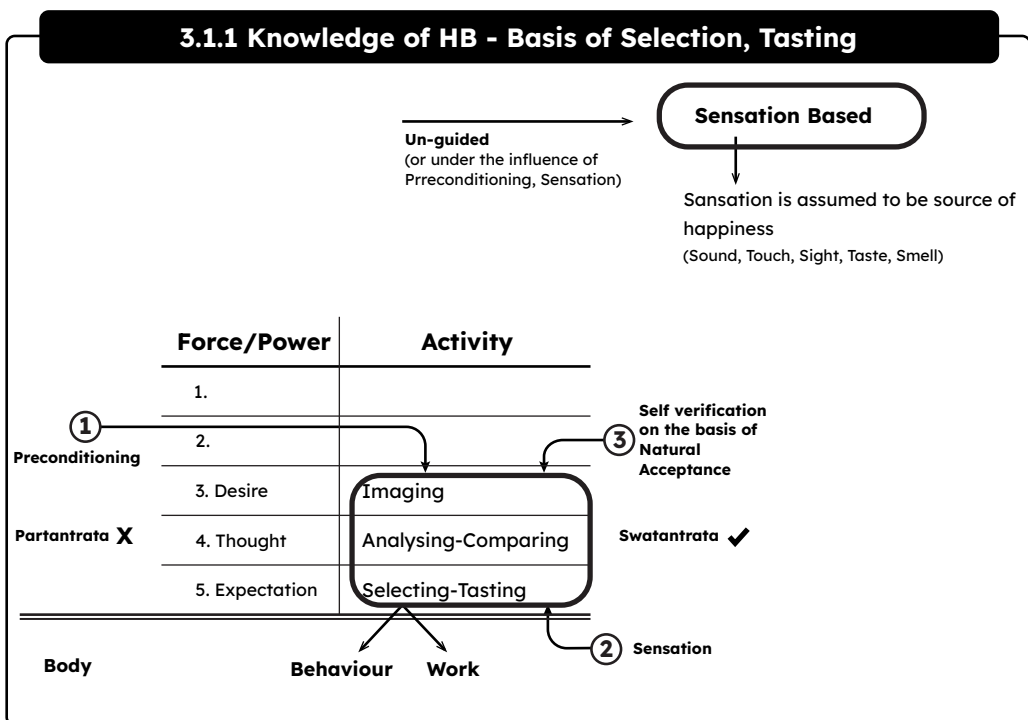
Lecture 14

Basis for Selecting-Tasting

Recap

In the previous lecture, we discussed the impact of higher activities on the activities of analyzing and comparing. In this lecture, we will discuss the impact of higher activities of the self on the activities of selecting and tasting.

14.1 Impact of Higher Activities on Desire



We have already discussed the higher activities of realization, understanding and contemplation. This understanding will now guide the desire, i.e., imaging of the self, and now I naturally have the desire to live with co-existence, harmony and relationship. I have to be aware whether this is

happening or not. If it is not happening, I have to find out the reason. I have to evaluate whether I am aware of my imagination and whether it is guided by the right understanding. If right understanding had taken place in me, I would be aware of it within myself and the activities of B1 would be guiding my desire in accordance with the co-existence, harmony and relationship. When we understand human-human relationship, the values in human-human relationship then our desire is to live with those values in human-human relationship. For example, when we see the feeling of trust clearly, we are able to distinguish between intention and competence. It makes all the difference in our desire to participate in relationship. So, this is one thing that the arrow indicating from the contemplation to imaging is essentially, showing, that my desire is now guided by contemplation, understanding and realization.

Sources of Excitement (Temporary Happiness)

- | | |
|------------------|--|
| 2. Right Feeling | Trust, Respect, Affection, Care, Guidance,
Reverence, Glory, Gratitude, Love |
| - in Self (I) | Definite completion point, Continuity is possible, |
| - From Other | Temporary, Dependence on Other,
No completion point, Continuity not guaranteed |
| | |
| 3. Sensation, PF | Sound, Touch, Form, Taste, Smell |
| - Through Body | Temporary, Dependence on Body & Other,
No completion point, Continuity not guaranteed |
| | Tasty-Necessary → Tasty-Unnecessary → Tasteless-Unnecessary → Intolerable |

14.2 Basis for Selecting and Tasting

Now we will study the impact of higher-level activities on the activities of selecting and tasting. Presently, our basis at the level of selecting and tasting is mostly sensation. So, most of the time when we are selecting something, we are selecting it on the basis of whether it will give us a favorable sensation

or not. If something is tasty, you select to eat. If something is not tasty, you don't select to eat. Most of the cases of overweight in the society are due to the selection based on the sensations. If something is tasty, we tend to eat even if it is not good for health of the body or even if the stomach is full. We are trying to get sensations from outside without understanding the role of sensation. We are under the influence of Pre-conditioning and Sensations. The basic motivation to select something like this, even if it is harmful to body, is to get happiness from outside which cannot be continuous. When we realize the source of continuous happiness in the light of higher activities, we can see that the source is the right understanding, right feeling in the self. However, people are trying to ensure the happiness from

(i) feelings from others

(ii) and, sensation from the body.

Both of these sources cannot ensure the continuity of happiness, rather they lead to excitement. A sincere evaluation will reveal that sensation is rather for evaluating the state of the other self and to identify and fulfil my complementary role with the other. We have already seen it before, but we have just placed it again here for drawing certain important conclusions. The sensation is basically, used for evaluating the state of physical facility. We use it to determine if the certain physical facility is okay for nurturing and protection of the body, and also, use it as a means for behavior and work for sharing the knowledge and the feeling. So, the basic source of happiness is right understanding, right feeling in the self.

Sources of Continuous Happiness

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1. Right Understanding
- in Self (I) | Harmony at all levels of being
Human Being, Family, Society, Nature/Existence
Definite completion point, Continuity is possible, Swatantrata |
| 2. Right Feeling
- in Self (I) | Trust, Respect, Affection, Care, Guidance,
Reverence, Glory, Gratitude, Love
Definite completion point, Continuity is possible, Swatantrata |

Purpose of Right Understanding, Right Feeling, Sensation/PF

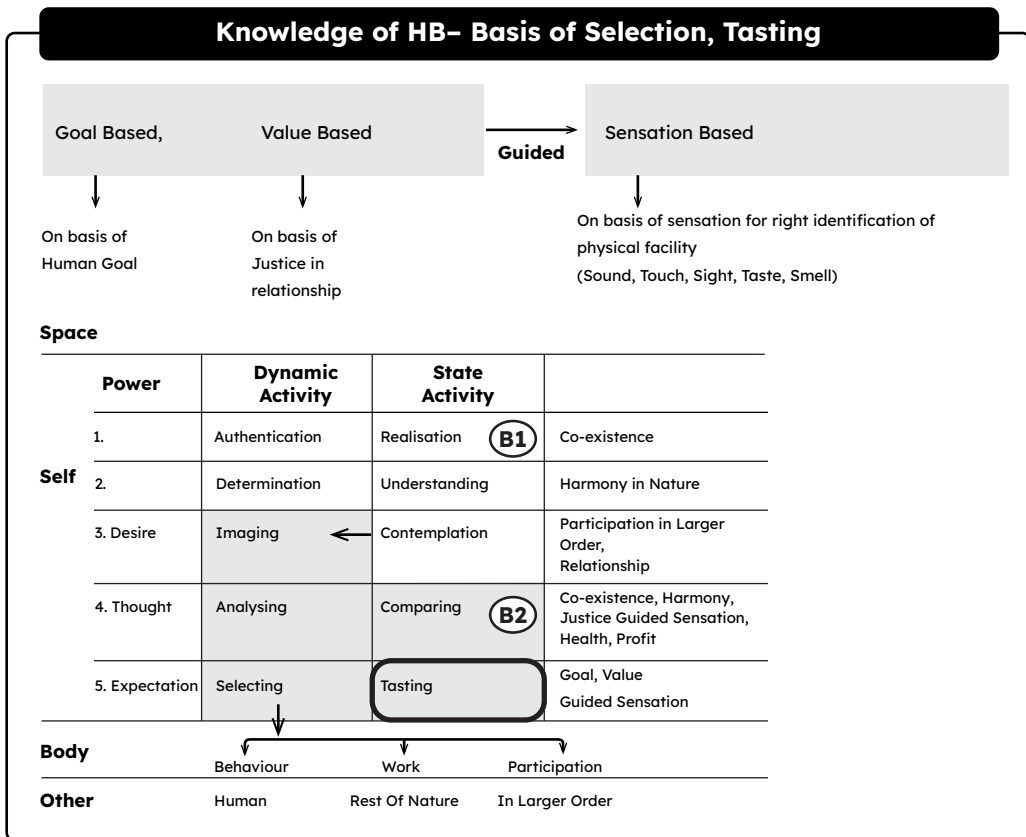
1. Right Understanding	Harmony at all levels of being Human Being, Family, Society, Nature/Existence
- in Self (I)	Definite completion point, Continuity is possible, Swatantrata
2. Right Feeling	Trust, Respect, Affection, Care, Guidance, Reverence, Glory, Gratitude, Love
- in Self (I)	Definite completion point, Continuity is possible, Swatantrata
- From Other	Temporary, Dependence on Other, No completion point, Continuity not guaranteed
3. Sensation, PF	Sound, Touch, Form, Taste, Smell
- Through Body	For evaluating state of physical facility to identify if it is OK for nurturing, protection of body (health of body) For behaviour/work, sharing knowledge, feeling

14.3 Three kinds of Tasting

If I have the right understanding, my basis of selecting and tasting is not only the sensation. Now, we will talk about the other two bases of my selection. With right understanding, when I am selecting something tasty, I don't only taste the sensation but I also taste whether it is going to be conducive to human goal or not at the level of individual and then at the level of society. I will also check whether it is according to the value in relationships or not. So, these bases will now start adding during my selection and tasting. Thus, there are three bases of selecting, tasting:

1. Goal based: on the basis of human goal
2. Value based: on the basis of justice in relationship
3. Sensation based: on the basis of sensation

With right understanding, the sensation-based tasting is guided by goal based, value based tasting. The sensation is now utilized for right identification of physical facility for nurturing, protection and right utilization of the body.



The goal-based selection can be seen in terms of realization of co-existence, self-awakening and fulfilment of the human goal. The value-based selection can be seen in terms of the relationship. Therefore, in the light of higher activities, our bases of selection will be based on co-existence, harmony and relationship and the sensation will be rightly utilized. Now, in the process of self-exploration, whenever I select something, I will ask myself whether my selection leads to the realization of co-existence in the self? Does my selection lead to the awakening in the self? Does my selection lead to happiness and bliss in the self? Does it lead to Harmony with entire nature? Does it lead to the participation in the larger order? Does it lead to right understanding and resolution in the self? Does it lead to fulfilment in relationship? Now, the identification of physical facility is for nurturing, protection and right utilization of the body. And this becomes the basis of selection of any physical facility. We can better understand

this with an example of a mother cooking for the family. When she cooks food, she takes care of food which is conducive to our health as well as tasty. She's not cooking the food only for creating a favorable sensation and getting happiness out of it but she is doing it as a part of this fulfilment of relationship with her child. That's why, when the mother cooks the food, she does not eat herself first, she will give the child first. We can explore here whether it is happening because of the sensation or the value, the feeling of care? If the feeling of care is not there, this mother would like to eat first, and then give to her child. We can see the difference.

14.4 Need for Awakening of Higher-Level Activities

If you are committed towards your realization of co-existence, you may have to go through situation which may not be very favorable in terms of sensation. Therefore, when you look at these higher activities and see their impact on the lower activities, you will see that the higher level activities are doing these three things-

- i. Observing the lower activities
- ii. Evaluating the lower activities and
- iii. Inspiring the lower level activities in terms of co-existence, harmony and relationship

The present situation is such that we are working with the lower activities and higher activities are not yet activated. Therefore, the activity at the lower level is unguided, and if it is unguided, it is creating all kinds of problems at the level of individual, family and society. In that case, what is the solution? The solution is to awaken ourselves to the higher activities and then these higher activities become the guide for the lower activities. If that happens, we get continuous happiness and our behavior, our work and our participation in the larger order would result into harmonious society and universal human order ensuring mutual happiness and mutual prosperity in every participation, and that is what we intend at individual level. In the next lecture, we will discuss the sources of happiness in detail.

Key Takeaways

There are three bases of selecting-tasting: Goal based, Value based and Sensation based. With right understanding, the sensation-based tasting is guided by goal based, value-based tasting. The goal-based selection is in terms of realization of co-existence, self-awakening and fulfilment of human goal. The value-based selection is in terms of the relationship.

Lecture 15

Possible Sources of Happiness

Recap

In the previous lectures, we talked about the higher activities of self in depth which relates to the idea of ensuring our fulfilment of basic aspiration - continuity of happiness. We also said that the higher activities of the self are definite, universal and continuous. And, if they start guiding the lower activities of the self, the self will be in the state of harmony within in continuity. Therefore, if our feeling and thought is all in line with the higher activities every moment, I can be in harmony at every moment; I can be in the state of happiness every moment.

In this lecture, we will discuss the possible sources of happiness.

15.1 Possible Sources of Happiness

So one way to ensure the continuity of happiness is by way of ensuring right understanding in the self or awakening to the higher activities of the self which leads to right feelings and thoughts.

But we might have been carrying so many notions about happiness and the ways to ensure happiness. In this lecture we will study all those assumptions. This is important because unknowingly most of us have such notions sitting in us as a set of pre-conditionings, as a set of assumptions, as a set of beliefs, and they keep troubling us. So, we must look at them, and evaluate them. And when we are able to evaluate them, then we are able to set them right. If they are already right we will have their continuity, and if they are not right, they will surely vanish. So, with that intention, we are trying to look into the possible sources of happiness that we might have been working on in the past and or what we might be working on at the moment. If we look at the right program for happiness, it can be summed up as:

Awakening to the higher activities of the self

(Being able to see relationship, harmony and co-existence in this nature, in this existence)

→

Desire (feeling), thought and expectation getting in line with the relationship, the harmony and the coexistence every moment

This ensures that the self is in harmony within and therefore, in a state of happiness within every moment, in continuity. This state of harmony at different levels of activities of the self is felt as Bliss, Satisfaction, Peace and Happiness which we discussed in previous lectures in detail. However, we are briefly recalling them. Bliss for example is an indication of harmony between realization and understanding. So, this Bliss is felt at the level of understanding when there is harmony between the realization and the understanding. This realization results in the understanding of co-existence, understanding of mutual fulfilment, understanding of self-organization and this understanding is in line with the realization of co-existence. So, in this state I can see that everything is definite, everything is certain, existence is in the form of co-existence and every unit in nature has a definite selforganization, definite innateness. When I can see that definiteness without any fluctuation, I can see universality and all those other things mentioned above as well, then, my state of mind is what we are calling as Bliss. With this, at the level of understanding, everything seems to be definite, everything seems to be certain. There is no indefiniteness, uncertainty, and therefore, there is no reason to worry. In fact all our worries are because of uncertainty, indefiniteness. So, when we say continuous happiness it includes all these four states: Bliss, Satisfaction, Peace and Happiness. With this, now we can see that the sources of continuous happiness are

1. Right understanding in the self
2. Right feeling and right thought in the self

Right understanding means - understanding of relationship, harmony and co-existence which in other words can be said as harmony at all levels of being, starting from human being, family, society, nature and ultimately, at the level of existence. And when we talk about this right understanding, it

has definite completion point, its continuity is possible and it leads to state of self-organization ('Swatantrata').

However, when we look at what we have been doing to get happiness, we find that we try many possible ways. It is important to explore all the ways which we are trying to get happiness because many of us must be having some of beliefs or assumptions lingering on our mind learned from the society in the form of presumptions, preconditioning or beliefs. All those assumptions are dumped in our imagination. Now we have to find whether these assumptions, either right or wrong, are in me with awareness or unawareness. If they exist in me with awareness, it is fine otherwise we have to get rid of them.

15.2 Sources of Temporary Happiness

Sources of temporary happiness or excitement:

1. One source is through feelings from others like the feeling of respect, affection, gratitude. Here, we are not thinking in terms of ensuring these feelings in ourselves, rather we are thinking in terms of getting the feelings from others, so that we can be in a state of harmony and happiness within.
2. The other source is through sensation from the body. We may be trying to get happiness through some sensation from the body like sensation of sound, touch, form, taste, smell. For example, some good smell makes me happy, some good taste of sweet makes me happy etc.

So, these are some possible sources of happiness for us today. In fact, you really look into yourself and find out what are the sources of happiness that you consider?

Do you consider right understanding and right feeling as a source of happiness or you consider getting the right feeling from others as source of happiness or you think that getting the favorable sensation is going to be a source of happiness?

With the above sources of happiness, there are the following problems:

a. The main problem with the above sources is that whenever I try to get happiness from something outside, I get happiness temporarily. Continuity is not possible.

b. Another issue with these two sources of happiness is that I become dependent on something outside.

So, I have become a slave to the other with this expectation.

c. Thirdly, there is no completion point. So, you do not know how much feeling should you get and for how long.

d. Fourthly, it is not definite whether you will get it from outside or not. Hence, there is always a feeling of indefiniteness involved, and happiness is not definite.

In fact, you will see when you go for the sensation for happiness or try to borrow some feeling from the other, it soon leads to the state of unhappiness.

15.3 Purpose of Right Understanding, Right Feeling, Sensation, Physical Facility

Now let us explore the purpose of Right Understanding, Right Feeling, Sensation and Physical Facility. If I correctly understand things, each of these will have a definite purpose.

Right understanding is used for the purpose of ensuring happiness in the self and there is a definite completion point.

I can evaluate the state of the other's self by observing their feelings. So, this feeling from others is not the source of happiness or unhappiness for me. Now it is just the piece of information to evaluate the state of the other person and once I am able to evaluate the state of the self of the other, I can define my complementarity with him/her. I can work out how I can be helpful to the other with that state of the self. So, that is going to be the purpose of reading the feeling from the others.

Similarly, when it comes to sensation, this cannot be the source of the happiness, continuous happiness for the self. It can be used for evaluating the state of physical facility. So, if I am getting the sensation of fever, I can

evaluate this that my body is being affected by cold. Similarly, I can use the sensation to identify the nurturing and protection of a body. For example, if I put something on my tongue and I get a sensation indicating that it is getting rotten, then I can decide that this is not good for the health of a body and finally the sensation is being used for behavior, work, for sharing knowledge. You listen to some words and get a sensation. Then you work on that information and you are able to get something, understanding something out of it. So, the other is able to share his feeling with you with the help of the sensation and make a dialogue with you.

15.4 Outcome of the Prevailing Notions of Happiness

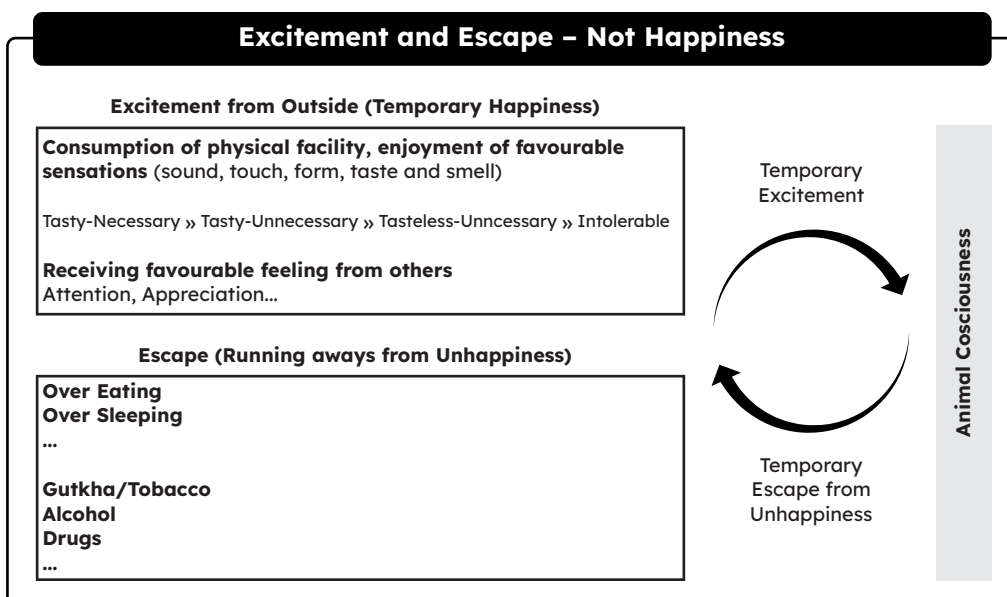
Let us explore the outcome of the effort to get happiness from the above sources one by one. If we are trying to get happiness through sensation, through pleasure, we get busy in accumulating and consuming more and more physical facility. If you are trying to get attention, appreciation..... the favorable feeling, we are stuck in getting happiness from others. With right evaluation of physical facility, we can see that physical facility is required for human being but it is not sufficient to ensure continuity of happiness.

If we try to get happiness from sensation, we can find the following sequence: Initially it is tasty, necessary

→ then it becomes tasty – unnecessary → then it becomes tasteless – unnecessary → and ultimately, then it becomes intolerable.

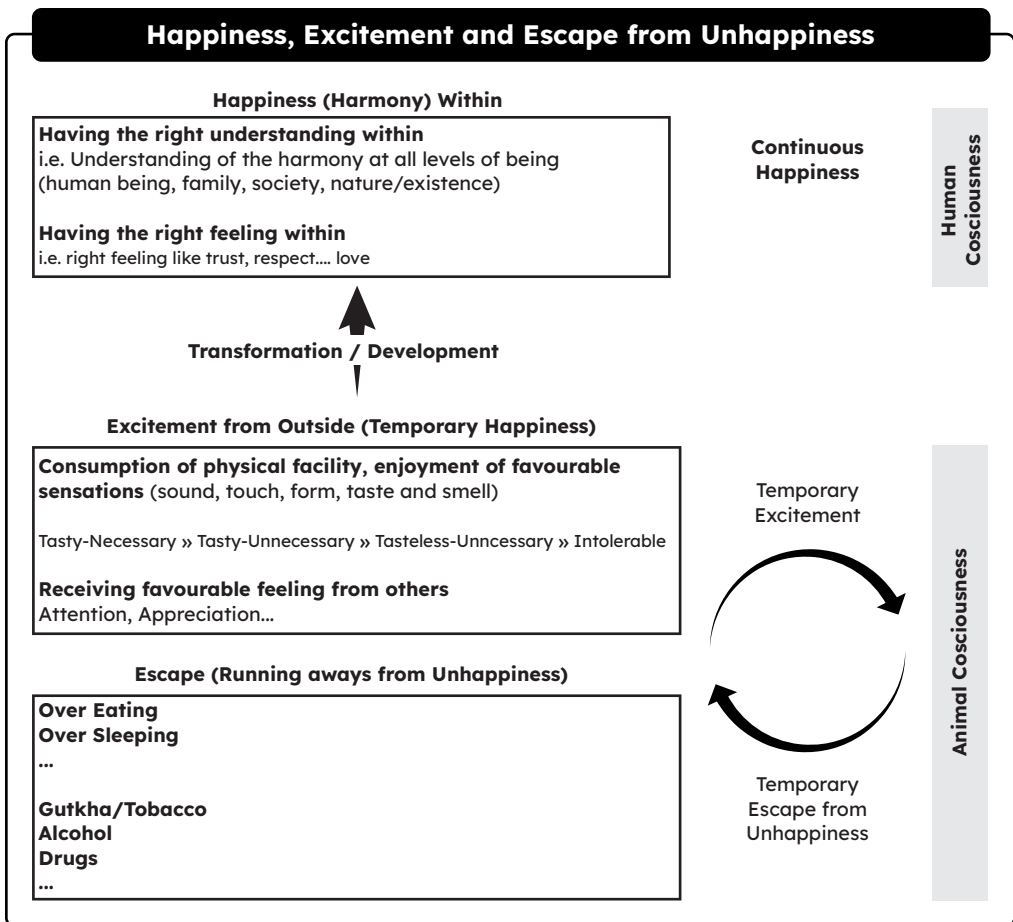
If you are trying to get happiness through attention, through appreciation from others or favorable feeling from others, you get dependent on others. This dependence cannot be continuous because the other person has his own life, his own engagement. So, the outcome of these efforts is that sometimes we are in the state of happiness which is basically, temporary happiness, a state of excitement and sometimes we are in the state of unhappiness, so, to say state of depression. So, if we have made this as a source of happiness, we are bound to get into the excitement or depression. And certainly when we are not able to ensure our happiness, there are two possibilities

1. I make effort for ensuring continuity of happiness by using different sources of excitement (say different tastes, different people to interact with) which most of us are doing.
2. If I am not able to manage it and somewhere I have a doubt about myself, then I run away from it. That is what we are calling as escape. So, there is a situation of unhappiness and I cannot deal with it, I cannot handle it and I am overpowered by it. Then I try to escape from that state of unhappiness, that state of depression.



15.5 Some Prevailing Means of Escape

We take to escape from unhappiness and do get into activities like overeating, oversleeping, intoxication like eating some kind of Gutka, tobacco, alcohol, drugs. And in the worst case one may get violent and commit suicide. This is happening in most of the suicidal cases. By this way, people are going into isolation, taking drugs, alcohol etc. Therefore, we keep oscillating between excitement and escape and we are not able to ensure continuity of happiness. So, this is the loop we have got into. We are trying to get this temporary happiness, this excitement from outside by consumption of physical facility, enjoyment of favorable sensation or by receiving favorable feelings from the others. All these efforts are actually for excitement.



15.6 A Way Out

As discussed above, we are either trying to get happiness from excitement or trying to escape from unhappiness. So one can observe the current state regarding these two things. And certainly, one needs to transform from this state to the desired state. And this transformation, this development, actually means ensuring right understanding in the self, right feeling in the self, right thought in the self. Having the right understanding within and having the right feeling within, this will lead to a state of continuous happiness. So, the transformation has to take place. And that essentially means transformation from animal consciousness to human consciousness. If you are living with animal consciousness, you are fluctuating between temporary happiness

and unhappiness, i.e., excitement and depression. And there is a need to transform to human consciousness where we have right understanding, right feeling and right thought, so that we will be in the state of harmony and happiness in continuity.

The only way to get out of this vicious cycle is to ensure right understanding, right feeling and thereby ensuring harmony in the self, happiness in the self. If we understand that everything in existence is in relationship, harmony, co-existence, we can have feelings based on this. And that will lead to the state of harmony within, state of happiness within. And if I can ensure these feelings every moment, I can ensure the continuity of happiness. And if this happens, of course, we can guarantee the state of Happiness, Peace, Satisfaction and Bliss which we have already talked about.

The important question is that how to work with this method? One possible way to work is through the exercises described under practice session of this course. Steps 4-5 in the exercises are helpful in investigating the reality by direct observation. So, when we see things by direct observation, we are able to see the reality in its completeness. Then, it becomes possible for me to see that relationship, harmony and co-existence are naturally acceptable to us and therefore, they are very much natural for us. And with this I can be in a state of harmony or happiness within.

Key Takeaways

The sources of continuous happiness are i) Right understanding in the self and ii) Right feeling (and right thought) in the self. The sources of temporary happiness are i) Right feeling from others and ii) Sensation through the body. When we try to work for temporary happiness, of course, there is no continuity, one becomes dependent on the other, there is no completion point and getting happiness is not definite too. Thus, one keeps on shifting between excitement and escape. The way out is to work on continuous sources of happiness.